

NPTEL Online Certification: Processes and timelines involved

Tentative Timelines:

Tasks and Timelines for July 2026	
Courses open for Enrolment	May 2026
Faculty Task	Timelines
Video Recording and Editing to be completed by	April 30, 2026
Assignments with all solutions for all weeks to be submitted to the NPTEL office (Minimum of One per week)	April 30, 2026
2 final certification question papers to be submitted	April 30, 2026
Text Transcript verification to be completed by	2 weeks before the course end date
Checking and answering questions on the forum	At least once every day
Final Score sign off (Online exams)	Within 3 days of sharing scores
Final Score sign off (Offline exams)	Within 2 weeks of sharing papers

Guidelines:

Course formats

Type	Total lecture duration	Course offered over a period of	Remarks
1	30 hours	12 weeks	Individual lectures durations are limited to a max of 30 min.
2	20 hours	8 weeks	
3	10 hours	4 weeks	

Course Contents

Content for one week

2.5 to 3 hours of video lectures per week

The video content should include about [half hour of tutorial](#) section, which can show how to solve problems similar to assignment

Every video should have a lecture title, concepts covered and keywords required for it to be searchable on YouTube.

Duration of each video – to be between 20 and 30 minutes, not more than that.

Every video can have an “[Activity question](#)” – a self-test question to check if they have understood

Also can have a “Think about this” question

[Additional reading material](#) – in terms of Journal papers and other interesting videos to be watched can be given.

Optional:

- Can add videos from guest faculty and other industry professionals – where possible as add on content

- Different formats of lectures such as group discussions (with students or other experts), maybe even a lecture by some other guest lecturer can be had, presentations from the students
- Demo of any tools used as part of the course.
- We can record experiments of labs associated with the course – so that users can atleast watch these even if they cannot perform

An assignment based on content for the week (10-15 questions; 3 or 4 can be recall; 3 or 4 can be problem solving; 1 or 2 based on extra reading – engagement of 1 to 2 hours)- for every week of course duration

Types of questions in an assignment:

MCQ, MSQ – auto grading / no problem (Check the score configured for each question)

- Multiple Choice (MCQ, single correct);
- Multiple select (MSQ, one or more correct choices);
- Avoid using “All of the above” and “None of the above”.
- If an MCQ has four options, blindly choosing a guess has a 25% chance of being correct. But if you have six options, that drops to 17%. With 8 options, it is 12.5%. You can go up to eight options in MCQ (more are also possible, if needed)

Fill in the blanks (numeric)

- Unless the answer is an integer, only specify a range for the answer and not an exact value.
- Answer to be entered is numeric: 0-9 and a decimal point are allowed.
- **Range** is preferred to allow for approximations. Range can be based on whatever error is acceptable (e.g., if the answers are like 1.71 to 1.73, the error seems to be + or - 0.01)
- Make sure whether the range given is sufficient enough taking into account all approximations people may do.
- In some cases, if it is a 1-step problem and you may want the students to learn the importance of being precise and not round off excessively then you don't have to broaden the range.

Fill in the blanks (alphanumeric) – will be auto graded

- a. There may be a problem with alphanumeric answers as every extra space or character in the answer will be a mismatch with correct answer and not give the user correct marks.
- b. Exact answer match is only possible in the portal, better to give Single word answers in this type

Fill in the blanks (numeric array) – will be auto graded. Matrix type questions can be configured using this.

Document upload - manual grading

- a. Course staff who are the people who would be correcting the subjective assignments, should be added before the assignment is made public – else allocation will not happen.
- b. After evaluation, only if the scores are entered on the portal will it be visible to the students. Or at least scores have to be published to the students through some other means.
- c. Evaluation deadline will be 2 weeks from the due date of the assignment

- d. Deletion or moving the files from the folder created causes the same to be inaccessible via the portal.
- e. Mention the total marks for the assignment. - Evaluation should be done out of 100

Essay type questions - manual grading - same as above.

Question papers 2 sets of question papers of identical level of 100 marks each. If the assignments are online assessment type (MCQ, Short answer type), the final exam papers should preferably be online type only.

Certification Criteria

Certification score will have 25% weightage from the weekly assignment scores and 75% weightage of the final certification exam score (for any non-programming course).

Honorarium for a New course:

Duration	Faculty Honorarium		TA Honorarium
	Content creation	Running the course	
4 Weeks	1,00,000	50,000	50,000
8 Weeks	2,00,000	1,00,000	1,00,000
12 Weeks	3,00,000	1,50,000	1,50,000

When the course is offered in a rerun mode, the Faculty and TA honorarium is limited to the runtime activities of the course i.e. without the content creation budget.

Text transcripts for the videos

NPTEL office will transcribe the videos and give the text to the faculty member - they need to nominate someone to go through the same and correct the errors. This has a separate honorarium component of Rs 1500 per hour of video transcript. These will be shared as notes along with the lecture. Where possible, we will also translate and provide the transcript in local languages.

Review of course video quality:

If not using NPTEL studio facility, but recording is being done using some other software, we request you to send 2 or 3 videos to us so that we may review the same and give suggestions if any.

The course contents are not as such reviewed before the course offering but based on feedback received, we decide on re-offering of the courses.

Conduct of courses

- The course will be opened for enrolment and publicized among the general public and NPTEL local chapters.

- Once the course starts, every week content and assignment have to be released and the discussion forum has to be handled for any queries and doubts.
- Conduct a live session for the students once a month at least during the course run.
- An in-person proctored certification exam is conducted for every course offered, which can be taken if desired, which is a requirement to get a certificate. This comes for a fee which on taking students can get a certificate if he/she gets more than 40% marks. 2 question papers will be required for this and the results will have to be evaluated and finalized by the faculty member. Logistics of exam will be handled by the NPTEL office.

Internship

To motivate the learners, internship opportunities are offered to the candidates completing the courses in the Topper or Elite+Gold category during Summer or Winter. For this, the faculty will be shared with the details of eligible candidates after the declaration of result to select the candidates. The faculty may indicate number of interns they are willing to take and the duration (4/6/8/10/12 weeks).

The internships are preferred to be offered the in-person mode and virtual mode can be considered for the faculty/PwD candidates under the compelling circumstances.

A token stipend @ Rs. 15,000 per 4-weeks of in-person internship is paid to the interns to meet their lodging and boarding expenses. However, no additional compensation is payable to the Faculty for offering internship. A certificate is issued to the student on completion of the internship.

Guidelines for Copyright issues:

- **All the material created is distributed under the license CC-BY-NC-SA and any images/content used as part of the videos should not be copyrighted by anyone else.**
- Hence any material used in the lectures should also be under this license or appropriate permissions must be sought from the sources for using the same. (These are more applicable for images/articles/standards from books and journal papers).
- Also wherever such images/videos are used, appropriate acknowledgement should be made quoting the source URL. If permission has not been obtained, images need to be redrawn.
- If videos (YouTube or otherwise) are to be used, they should not be embedded in the course videos but only the link should be provided, which the learners need to view independently.
- Journal papers cannot be shared directly - They can add the full abstract of the paper and actual doi (or link in the Journal's site).

If the video is copyrighted to someone else, better to

- (i) either get the permission for use from them
- (ii) or safer to give the links to the videos rather than embed. Previously YouTube found videos embedded in another by audio, so if audio was muted, then claims were not made. But nowadays matches are happening with images also.